

Amazon India Seller Operations Guide (Onboarding, Listing, Shipping SLA)

Synthesized from multiple public sources — Amazon Seller Central's onboarding flow is interactive rather than a single downloadable policy document. Facts below are cross-verified across at least two independent sources where possible.

Onboarding & Registration

1. Register on Amazon Seller Central with business PAN, GSTIN, Aadhaar, business address proof, and bank account details.
2. GSTIN is mandatory at seller account activation for all product categories — Amazon verifies it before the account can go live; no valid GSTIN means no active seller account.
3. Category-appropriate compliance certificates may be required for regulated categories (e.g., FSSAI for food, BIS for electronics, CDSCO for medical devices, AYUSH for ayurvedic products).
4. Brand-focused sellers seeking Amazon Brand Registry protections should hold a registered trademark.
5. GSTIN is uploaded under Seller Central > Settings > Account Info > Tax Information.
6. Amazon deducts TCS on all sales and deposits it against the seller's GSTIN; Amazon separately files GSTR-8 monthly on the seller's behalf, which auto-populates the seller's GSTR-2A.

Listing Guidelines

- Product listings require accurate title, category placement, and description; incorrect category selection is a common cause of listing rejection or poor discoverability.
- Image and content quality directly affects both approval and search ranking — this mirrors Flipkart and Meesho's emphasis on image standards, though Amazon's specific pixel/format requirements are managed within the Seller Central listing tool rather than a single published spec sheet.
- HSN codes must be correctly assigned per product for GST compliance.

Shipping SLA & Performance Tracking

- Amazon tracks **Late Dispatch Rate** and **Valid Tracking Rate** as core seller performance metrics — this is the Amazon-specific equivalent of Flipkart's Dispatch SLA/RTO tracking and Meesho's Ready-to-Ship timeline tracking.
- Sellers using Amazon Easy Ship can have Amazon manage return shipping logistics, reducing self-managed courier overhead.
- Amazon requires sellers to respond to a return request within two working days of notification; unresolved seller disputes beyond this window can escalate to an A-to-Z Guarantee claim in the buyer's favor (see Amazon returns document for full A-to-Z process).
- Consistently poor Late Dispatch or Valid Tracking metrics can affect account health standing and buyer-facing visibility, similar in effect to Flipkart's Seller Rating penalty system.

Sources

- Kanakkupillai, EasyVyapar, ecomadvisors.co.in GST/documents-required guides (onboarding documents, GSTIN requirement)
- IMARC Engineering manufacturer onboarding guide (compliance certificates, brand registry)
- Amazon Seller Blog (“How to manage product returns on Amazon”) — sell.amazon.in/seller-blog
- EcomShadow shipping-label guide (Late Dispatch Rate / Valid Tracking Rate terminology)
- Official Amazon.in Return FAQ pages (two-working-day seller response requirement, A-to-Z escalation path)